Date: 2026-10-19

notes on papers

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[1] "vibranye.pdf"
[2] "shklovsky, art as device (berliner).pdf"
[3] "shklovsky-viktor-the-resurrection-of-the-word.pdf"
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(13) annotations: shklovsky-viktor-the-resurrection-of-the-word.pdf

paper: Shklovsky (1914)

page

note

comment

2

not ‘recognise’ the familiar word.

2

This loss of the form of the word represents a great easement for the thought-processes and may be a necessary condition for the existence of science, but art could never be satisfied with this eroded word

3

Here the decoration is not made, it is ‘narrated’ and relies on people not seeing it, but on their recognising it and saying - ‘it’s the same’.

3

if we sense the nobility and humanity of the thoughts of the most humane poets in the world, then these sensations have nothing in common with art

4

NA

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4

The ‘arbitrary’ and ‘derived’ words of the Futurists have been born.

4

poetic devices are the devices of general linguistic thoughtprocesses, simply introduced by them into poetry

4

but we have become too used to setting up comprehensibility as a necessary requirement of poetic language.

4

this sort of semi-comprehensible language seems to the reader, by reason of its unfamiliarity, more figurative

4

Futuristy) poets are on the right path: they have correctly evaluated the old forms.

4

we pave ceased to be artists in everyday life, we do not love our houses and clothes, and easily part from a life of which we are not aware. Only the creation of new forms of art can restore to man sensation of the world, can resurrect things and kill pessimism.

4

split it up by rhyme, like Mayakovsky

4

reminiscent of that polished surface of which Korolenko spoke: ’across it runs the plane of thought, touching nothing.

(18) annotations: shklovsky, art as device (berliner).pdf

paper: Shklovsky (2015)

page

note

comment

2

appeared in an earlier issue of Poetika in 1917

2

these terms are associated with Bertolt Brecht's Verfremdung and interpersonal estrangement (as in "she is estranged from her family"). These two concepts suggest decreased emotional connection to people, fictional or real, which is the opposite of the intended effect of ostranenie

8

The better you comprehend an epoch, the better can you see that the images you believed to be created by a particular poet are actually borrowed from others and almost unchanged

8

images turn out to be almost immobile; they flow, unchanging, from century to century, from country to country, from poet to poet

8

Images are a given, and poetry is not so much thinking in images as remembering them.

8

an enormous sphere of art turned out not to be a method of thinking; one of the arts constituting this sphere, lyrical poetry, is nevertheless very similar to "image-bearing" art: it uses words in the same way; most importantly, image-bearing art flows into imageless art quite imperceptibly, and we experience the two in similar ways.

8

art is, above all, the creator of symbols"

9

Russian eighteenth-century poets place adjectives after nouns

9

suggests that a given work depends in its artistry— in whether or not it is poetry— on our perception

10

like saying: head ¼ sphere, watermelon ¼ sphere. This is thinking, but it has nothing in common with poetry.

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10

Spencer's footsteps: "The merit of style consists precisely in delivering the greatest amount of thoughts in the fewest words."

11

22Yakubinsky's article, which states that the law of liquid consonant dissimilation is missing from poetic language and that in poetic language such hard-to-pronounce sound combinations are possible, is one of the first scientifically sound indications of the opposition (in this case, at least) between poetic language and practical language

11

. It is the automatization process which explains the laws of our prosaic speech, its understructured phrases and its half-pronounced words.(..)(..)This process is ideally expressed in algebra, which replaces things with symbols. In quick practical speech, words are not spoken fully; only their initial sounds are registered by the mind

12

And so this thing we call art exists in order to restore the sensation of life, in order to make us feel things, in order to make a stone stony.

12

. Algebraizing, automatizing a thing, we save the greatest amount of perceptual effort: things are either given as a single feature, for instance, a number, or else they follow a formula of sorts without ever reaching consciousness

12

The goal of art is to create the sensation of seeing, and not merely recognizing, things; the device of art is the "enstrangement" of things and the complication of the form, which increases the duration and complexity of perception

13

Tolstoy's method of estrangement consists in not calling a thing or event by its name but describing it as if seen for the first time, as if happening for the first time

21

46The language of poetry is difficult, laborious language which puts the brakes on perception

Shklovsky, Viktor. 1914. *The Resurrection of the Word*.

———. 2015. “Art, as Device.” Translated by Alexandra Berlina. *Poetics Today* 36 (3): 151–74. https://doi.org/10.1215/03335372-3160709.

